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Capabilities

Persistence

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Persistence lets LangGraph applications keep useful information beyond a single graph run. It matters when an agent needs to continue a conversation, resume after an interruption, recover from a failure, or remember information across interactions.

LangGraph provides two complementary persistence systems:

- **Checkpointers** persist a thread's graph state as checkpoints. Use them for short-term, thread-scoped memory, including conversation continuity, human-in-the-loop workflows, time travel, and fault tolerance.
- **Stores** persist application-defined data outside the graph state. Use them for long-term, cross-thread memory, including user preferences, facts, and shared knowledge.

Most applications can use both: a checkpointer tracks the current thread, and a store tracks durable information across threads.

Quickstart

Compile your graph with a checkpointer, a store, or both:

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```
graph = builder.compile(checkpointer=checkpointer, store=store)

result = graph.invoke(
    {"messages": [{"role": "user", "content": "Hi, my name is Bob."}]},
    {"configurable": {"thread_id": "thread-1"}},
)
```

 **Agent Server handles persistence automatically** When using the [Agent Server](#), you do not need to implement or configure checkpointer or stores manually. The server handles persistence infrastructure behind the scenes.

Checkpoint vs. store

	Checkpoint	Store
Persists	Graph state snapshots	Application-defined key-value data
Scope	A single thread	Across threads
Memory type	Short-term, thread-scoped memory	Long-term, cross-thread memory
Use for	Conversation continuity, human-in-the-loop, time travel, and fault tolerance	User preferences, facts, and shared knowledge
Access pattern	Pass a <code>thread_id</code> in graph config	Read and write items from nodes or application code
Full guide	Checkpoints	Stores

Troubleshooting common issues

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deterministic IDs:

```
import uuid

config = {"configurable": {"thread_id": str(uuid.uuid4())[:255]}}
```

MemorySaver does not persist between restarts

MemorySaver and **InMemorySaver** store checkpoints in RAM. When the process restarts, all checkpoints are lost.

Fix: Use a persistent checkpointer for production:

- **PostgresSaver** : PostgreSQL with async support
- **SqliteSaver** : Local file-based storage for development

Checkpoints growing unboundedly

Over long conversations, checkpoints accumulate. This can increase latency and storage costs.

Fix: Prune old checkpoints periodically or set a retention policy:

```
from langgraph.checkpoint.postgres import PostgresSaver

checkpointer = PostgresSaver.from_conn_string("postgresql://...")
checkpointer.setup() # Creates tables with indexes
# Consider adding a cron job to delete checkpoints older than N days
```

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Next steps

- [Use checkpoints](#) to persist and inspect thread state.
- [Use stores](#) to persist durable data across threads.

 [Connect these docs](#) to Claude, VSCode, and more via MCP for real-time answers.

 [Edit this page on GitHub](#) or [file an issue](#).

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